

The good news is that education works! An often-quoted study (“The Long-Term Effects of High School Financial Curriculum Mandates” by Bernheim, Garrett, and Maki) found that students exposed to a financial education mandate maintained a net worth that was about one year’s worth of earnings higher than the net worth of students not exposed to such a mandate. In addition, the National Endowment for Financial Education evaluated the curriculum it created for schools, called the High School Financial Planning Program, and discovered that as little as ten hours of classroom instruction can contribute to significant positive knowledge and behavioral changes in how teens handle their money. These findings provide strong evidence that education can reduce money mistakes and contribute to financial well-being.

This book chronicles common money mistakes many young adults make and provides instructions on how these mistakes can be avoided. Also included are real life stories gathered over my many years of working with people experiencing money problems. Their names have been changed in order to protect their identities. While not everyone who was profiled has changed his or her ways, with strength and courage you can break out of old habits and make your life more prosperous than it is now. Even though change is frightening to many, this book can help you gain control over your financial future.

